

A close-up photograph of two cellos, showing their wooden bodies, scrollwork, and tuning pegs. The cellos are positioned vertically, with their heads pointing towards the top of the frame. The lighting highlights the warm, polished wood against a dark, almost black background.

modern cello

life


Cello

School for music



Bach

Among the most well-known Baroque works for the cello are Johann Sebastian Bach's six unaccompanied Suites. Other significant works include Sonatas and Concertos by Antonio Vivaldi, and solo sonatas by Francesco Geminiani and Giovanni Bononcini. Domenico Gabrielli was one of the first composers to treat the cello as a solo instrument. As a basso continuo instrument the cello may have been used in works by Francesca Caccini (1587–1641), Barbara Strozzi (1619–1677) with pieces such as *Il primo libro di madrigali, per 2–5 voci e basso continuo, op. 1* and Elisabeth Jacquet de La Guerre (1665–1729), who wrote six sonatas for violin and basso continuo. Francesco Supriani's *Principij da imparare a suonare il violoncello e con 12 Toccate a solo* (before 1753), an early manual for learning the cello, dates from this era. As the title of the work suggests, it contains 12 toccatas for solo cello, which along with Johann Sebastian Bach's Cello Suites, are some of the first works of that type.

From the Classical era, the two concertos by Joseph Haydn in C major and D major stand out, as do the five sonatas for cello and pianoforte of Ludwig van Beethoven, which span the important three periods of his compositional evolution. Other outstanding examples include the three Concerti by Carl Philipp Emanuel Bach, Capricci by dall'Abaco, and Sonatas by Flackton, Boismortier, and Luigi Boccherini.

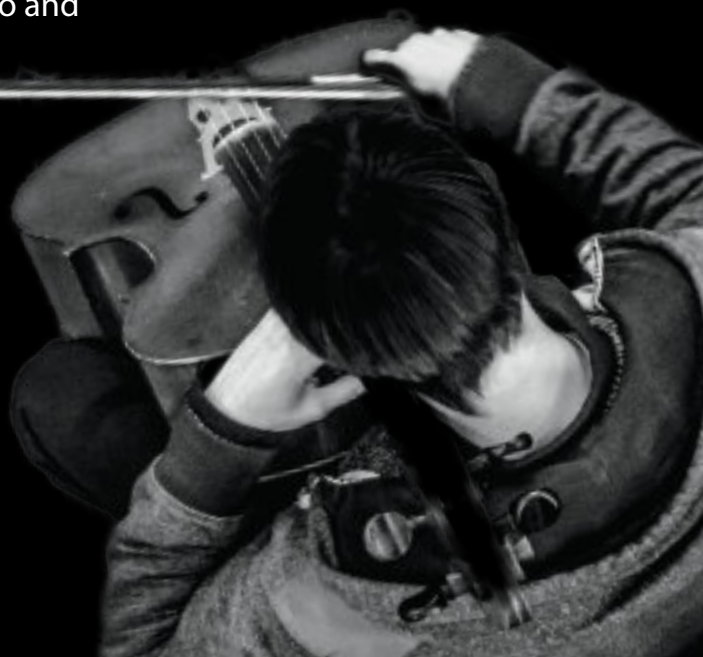
A *Divertimento for Piano, Clarinet, Viola and Cello* is among the surviving works by Duchess Anna Amalia of Brunswick-Wolfenbüttel (1739–1807). Wolfgang Amadeus Mozart supposedly wrote a Cello Concerto in F major, K. 206a in 1775, but this has since been lost. His *Sinfonia Concertante* in A major, K. 320e includes a solo part for cello, along with the violin and viola, although this work is incomplete and only exists in fragments, therefore it is given an Anhang number (Anh. 104).



Seeger

Well-known works of the Romantic era include the Robert Schumann Concerto, the Antonín Dvořák Concerto, the first Camille Saint-Saëns Concerto, as well as the two sonatas and the Double Concerto by Johannes Brahms. A review of compositions for cello in the Romantic era must include the German composer Fanny Mendelssohn (1805–1847), who wrote *Fantasia in G Minor* for cello and piano[5] and a *Capriccio in A-flat* for cello.

Compositions from the late 19th and early 20th century include three cello sonatas (including the *Cello Sonata in C Minor* written in 1880) by Dame Ethel Smyth (1858–1944), Edward Elgar's *Cello Concerto in E minor*, Claude Debussy's *Sonata for Cello and Piano*, and unaccompanied cello sonatas by Zoltán Kodály and Paul Hindemith. Pieces including cello were written by American Music Center founder Marion Bauer (1882–1955) (two trio sonatas for flute, cello, and piano) and Ruth Crawford Seeger (1901–1953) (*Diaphonic suite No. 2* for bassoon and cello).





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